

The Cost of Always Being Busy: A Signal

忙碌的代价：一个信号

Theme: 健康、运动与生活习惯 · New: 45 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 45/6, 127

English Story

They had crossed a border for a timetable; now the deadline was inside one body. The sixth arc opened with a **crisis** that nobody had anticipated: Daniel collapsed on the last step of the sports center **ladder**. An athlete of national standard, a **scout** for a professional club, and a **sportswoman** who trained with him three times a week all said the same thing: he had been eating the food of one **nap** and sleeping four hours. “It was not a **weapon**,” the doctor said. “It was a **situation**.”

I hope this becomes a lesson, not a story. The **concept** of **improvement** had been pressed on him by everyone: a **bunch** of small gains, a **particle** at a time, a **dosage** of training that would **make** him **curable** and quick. “You cannot **persuade** a body with **emphasis**,” the doctor said. “You can only **assist** it.” A **cosmic disturbance**, a **whale**, a **famine**, and the strike of the grocers were the metaphors the team invented to explain the delay. **Make** it simple, they said.

The **reunion** of the old rowing crew was still a week away, and the **refrigerator** in the common room was empty. Follow the training plan, the coach said; **take** the lift, **send** the form, and **bring** the **ladder** back. Who would **make** the first step? Our answer came from the church clinic, an hour north of the campus, where an **inhabitant** of the old town had starved himself into the same ward.

The **disturbance** was measurable: a **diameter** of two centimetres in the ankle, a pulse of a hundred and ten, and a weight that had dropped **farther** than any of them had guessed. “You cannot **escape** a body,” the doctor said. “You can only **involve** it in the plan.” A **disabled** swimmer and a surfer with a bad **chin** had both been through the same ward, and both had come back through the same door.

The last item on the sheet was the hardest: the **sportsman** who could not rest, the god of the timetable, the over-full week. “Training is not a punishment,” Daniel said at last. “Kill that idea and I will follow the plan.” An athlete had made the promise; a person would have to keep it. The question was not whether **anyone** could work harder; it was whether the change could **take place** at all. Nothing could **induce** him to sleep, and the week was over before the plan existed.

中文翻译

他们曾为一张时刻表跨越国界；而这一次，期限在一具身体里面。第六段弧线以一个没人预料到的危机开始：丹尼尔倒在体育中心梯子的最后一级上。一位国家级运动员、一位职业俱乐部的星探，以及一位每周和他一起训练三次的女运动员都说了同样的话：他吃的只够一次小睡，睡四个小时。“这不是武器，”医生说，“这是一种处境。”

我希望这成为一堂课，而不是一个故事。“进步”这个概念被所有人压在他身上：一束小小的收获、一次一粒、让他痊愈而敏捷的一剂训练。“你无法用强调说服一具身体，”医生说，“你只能协助它。”一场宇宙扰动、一头鲸、一场饥荒，以及食品商的罢市，是团队为了解释这次延误而发明的比喻。他们说，把它讲简单些。

老赛艇队的重聚还有一周，而公共休息室的冰箱是空的。按训练计划来，教练说；乘电梯、寄表格、把梯子拿回来。谁来迈出第一步？我们的答案来自校园以北一小时的那间教堂诊所，那里有位老城的居民把自己饿进了同一间病房。

这场扰乱是可以测量的：脚踝直径两厘米、脉搏一百一十，以及一个比他们任何人猜的都掉得更远的体重。“你无法逃离身体，”医生说，“你只能把它纳入计划。”一位残疾游泳者和一位下巴受伤的冲浪者都待过同一间病房，也都从同一扇门走了回来。

清单上最后一项最难：那个无法休息的运动员、时刻表的神、排满的一周。“训练不是惩罚，”丹尼尔终于说，“把这个想法杀掉，我就按计划来。”一位运动员做出了承诺；而要守住它的，得是一个人。问题不是有没有人能更努力；问题是这种改变到底能不能发生。没有什么能让他入睡，而那一周在计划形成之前就已经结束了。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
make meɪk POS: vt	vt. 制造, 安排, 创造, 构成, 使得, 产生, 造成, 整理, 布置, 引起, 到达, 进行; vi. 开始, 前进, 增大, 被制... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. engage in; v. give certain properties to something; v. make or cause to be or to become; v. compel or make so...
take teɪk POS: vt	vt. 拿, 取, 抓, 带领, 获得, 就座, 接受, 吃, 吸引, 采取, 乘, 需要, 花费; vi. 吃掉对方棋子, 抓住, 起作用... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of photographing a scene or part of a scene without interruption; v. carry out; v. require (time or)...
place pleɪs POS: n	n. 地方, 地点, 位置, 住所, 座位, 地位, 处境, 特权, 空间, 余地, 职务, 位; vt. 放置, 寄予, 认出, 评定, ... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. any area set aside for a particular purpose; n. an abstract mental location; n. a general vicinity; n. a part...
bring brɪŋ POS: vt	vt. 带来, 产生, 促使, 提出; vi. 生产 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. take something or somebody with oneself somewhere; v. cause to come into a particular state or condition; v. ...
send send POS: vt	vt. 发送, 使进入, 寄, 派遣, 发射, 使陷于; vi. 寄信, 派人, 播送; n. (船的)上升运动; [计] 发送 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. cause to go somewhere; v. to cause or order to be taken, directed, or transmitted to another place; v. trans...
involve ɪn'vɒlv POS: vt	vt. 包括, 使陷于, 潜心于, 包围; [医] 累及, 牵涉, 包含 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. connect closely and often incriminatingly; v. engage as a participant; v. contain as a part; v. occupy or eng...
situation ˌsɪtʃu'eɪʃən POS: n	n. 情形, 境遇, 位置; [医] 情境, 处境 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the general state of things; the combination of circumstances at a given time; n. a condition or position i...
eat i:t POS: v	v. 吃, 腐蚀 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. take in solid food; v. eat a meal; take a meal; v. worry or cause anxiety in a persistent way
anyone 'eniwʌn POS: pron	pron. 任何人 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. One taken at random rather than by selection; anybody.; [Commonly written as two words.]
sport spɔ:t POS: n	n. 运动, 游戏, 娱乐, 消遣, 玩笑; a. 运动的, 户外穿戴的; vi. 游戏, 参加体育运动, 戏弄, 产生变种; vt. 炫耀, ... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an active diversion requiring physical exertion and competition; n. the occupation of athletes who compete...
weapon 'wepən POS: n	n. 武器, 兵器; vt. 武装 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. any instrument or instrumentality used in fighting or hunting; n. a means of persuading or arguing
concept 'kɒnsɛpt POS: n	n. 观念, 概念; [医] 概念 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an abstract or general idea inferred or derived from specific instances
crisis 'kraɪsɪs POS: n	n. 危机, 危险期, 紧要关头; [医] 危象; 骤退, 临界, 极期 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an unstable situation of extreme danger or difficulty; n. a crucial stage or turning point in the course of...
improvement ɪm'pru:vmənt POS: n	n. 进步, 改善, 利用; [医] 改善, 好转, 进步 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a change for the better; progress in development; n. the act of improving something; n. a condition superior...
athlete 'æθli:t POS: n	n. 运动员, 运动选手; [医] 运动员 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person trained to compete in sports
escape ɪ'skeɪp POS: n	n. 逃亡, 避难设备, 逃跑; vi. 逃脱, 避开, 溜走; vt. 逃避, 避免, 被...忘掉 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of escaping physically; n. an inclination to retreat from unpleasant realities through diversion or...
emphasis 'emfə'sɪs POS: n	n. 强调, 加强, 重点, 强语气 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. special importance or significance; n. special and significant stress by means of position or repetition e. ...
persuade pə'sweɪd POS: vt	vt. 劝, 使相信, 恳求, 敦促, 说服; vi. 劝服, 被说服 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. cause somebody to adopt a certain position, belief, or course of action; twist somebody's arm
assist ə'sɪst POS: n	n. 帮助, 协助; vt. 帮助, 促进; vi. 协助, 参加 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. (sports) the act of enabling another player to make a good play; v. act as an assistant in a subordinate or...
bunch bʌntʃ POS: n	n. 串, 束; [医] 骨肿块(马) Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a grouping of a number of similar things; n. any collection in its entirety; v. gather or cause to gather in...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
disabled dis'eibld POS: a	a. 残废的, 有缺陷的, 失效的; [计] 失效的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. people collectively who are crippled or otherwise physically handicapped; s. incapable of functioning as a...
anticipate æn'tisipeit POS: vt	vt. 预期, 占先, 加速, 提前使用; [医] 提前出现, 先期发生 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. act in advance of; deal with ahead of time; v. realize beforehand; v. be excited or anxious about; v. be a fo...
particle 'pɑ:tɪkl POS: n	n. 颗粒, 粒子, 质点, 极小量; [化] 粒子; 质点 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a body having finite mass and internal structure but negligible dimensions; n. a function word that can be...
induce in'dju:s POS: vt	vt. 引诱, 招致, 归纳出, 感应; [医] 诱导, 感应 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. cause to arise; v. cause to do; cause to act in a specified manner; v. cause to occur rapidly; v. reason or e...
invent in'vent POS: vt	vt. 发明, 创作, 虚构; [机] 发明 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. come up with (an idea, plan, explanation, theory, or principle) after a mental effort
chin tʃɪn POS: n	n. 下巴, 颏; [医] 颏 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the protruding part of the lower jaw; v. raise oneself while hanging from one's hands until one's chin is l...
refrigerator rɪ'frɪdʒəreɪtə POS: n	n. 电冰箱, 冷藏库; [计] 冷冻机; 致冷器 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. white goods in which food can be stored at low temperatures
ladder 'lædə POS: n	n. 梯, 梯状物, 发迹的途径; vi. 袜子抽丝, 成名 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. steps consisting of two parallel members connected by rungs; for climbing up or down; n. ascending stages b...
inhabitant in'hæbɪtənt POS: n	n. 居民, 居住者; [医] 居民 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person who inhabits a particular place
whale hweɪl POS: n	n. 鲸; vi. 捕鲸; vt. 使惨败, 猛揍 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. any of the larger cetacean mammals having a streamlined body and breathing through a blowhole on the head; ...
disturbance dis'tɜ:bəns POS: n	n. 扰乱, 不安, 忧虑; [化] 扰动; 干扰; 失调 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an unhappy and worried mental state; n. a disorderly outburst or tumult; n. the act of disturbing something...
diameter daɪ'æmɪtə POS: n	n. 直径; [医] 直径, 径 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the length of a straight line passing through the center of a circle and connecting two points on the circ...
cosmic 'kɒzmɪk POS: a	a. 宇宙的, 宇宙航行的, 无限的, 有秩序的; [医] 宇宙的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. of or from or pertaining to or characteristic of the cosmos or universe; s. inconceivably extended in space...
reunion ri:'ju:njən POS: n	n. 团圆, 重聚; [医] 再连合, 复连[合] Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a party of former associates who have come together again; n. the act of coming together again
scout skaʊt POS: n	n. 守候, 侦察, 搜索, 侦察员, 侦察机; vi. 守候, 侦察, 巡视, 嘲笑; vt. 侦察, 跟踪, 发现, 监视, 嘲弄 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a Boy Scout or Girl Scout; n. someone employed to discover and recruit talented persons (especially in the...
famine 'fæmɪn POS: n	n. 饥荒, 缺乏, 饥饿 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a severe shortage of food (as through crop failure) resulting in violent hunger and starvation and death
nap næp POS: n	n. 小睡, 稍睡, 细毛, 孤注一掷; vi. 小睡, 疏忽; vt. 使拉毛, 打盹度过, 预测...为获胜马 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a soft or fuzzy surface texture; n. sleeping for a short period of time (usually not in bed); v. take a sies...
starve stɑ:v POS: v	v. (使)饿死, (使)挨饿 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. be hungry; go without food; v. die of food deprivation; v. deprive of food; v. deprive of a necessity and cau...
sportsman 'spɔ:tsmən POS: n	n. 运动员, 冒险家 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n someone who engages in sports
farther 'fɑ:ðə POS: a	a. 更远的, 进一步的; adv. 更远的, 此外, far的比较级 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. more distant in especially space or time; r. to or at a greater distance in time or space ('farther' is use...
grocer 'grəʊsə POS: n	n. 食品商 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a retail merchant who sells foodstuffs (and some household supplies)

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
dosage 'dəʊsɪdʒ POS: n	n. 剂量, 用量, 配药; [医] 剂量 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n the quantity of an active agent (substance or radiation) taken in or absorbed at any one time; n a measured...
curable 'kjʊərəbl POS: a	a. 可医治的, 医得好的; [医] 可愈的, 能治愈的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. curing or healing is possible; s. capable of being hardened by some additive or other agent
surfing 'sɜ:fɪŋ POS: n	n. 冲浪运动 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the sport of riding a surfboard toward the shore on the crest of a wave
sportswoman 'spɔ:tswʊmən POS: n	n. 女运动员 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n someone who engages in sports